Indigenous use of water

Indigenous Australians follow simple, scientific rules when setting up camp. The rules tell them how to use the water in the creek for everything they need without getting sick.



☞ **1** Imagine you are camping in a creek valley with your family. Plan your campsite. Decide where each of these actions would take place and list them in the table below.

- collect drinking water
- collect cooking water
- empty out cooking water
- wash bodies (bathe)
- let children swim
- let pets swim
- wash clothes
- wash dishes
- catch fish
- use toilet pit

Upstream	Near camp	Downstream	Away from creek

2 Why should washing and swimming take place downstream from where drinking water is collected?

_____

_____

3 Fill in the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) in the passage below.

CSIRO sc__ __nt__sts such as D__ct__r Sue Jackson and Brad Moggridge w__rk with Indigenous people to l__ __rn about m__n__g__ng rivers. The steady fl__w of a river brings fo__d and wat__r and a sense of w__llb__ __ng to Indigenous A__str__l__ __ns. The flow of the water has pr__ctical and spiritu__l importance, and __nd__g__n__ __s Australians h__ve learned how to manage their imp__ct on str__ams.

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